

SAMYUKTA KURIKALA

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EDUCATION

Northeastern University

Boston, MA

M.S. in Cybersecurity

September 2024 – May 2026

Related Coursework: Information System Forensics, Network Security, Linux Kernel Security

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Tools: Wazuh, Splunk, Wireshark, Sysmon, VirusTotal, Docker, Shuffle SOAR, TheHive

Platforms & Languages: Windows, Linux (Ubuntu/Debian), Python, PowerShell, Bash, SQL

Core Skills: SIEM/EDR, Alert Triage, Severity Classification, True/False Positive Validation, Incident Response, Playbook Execution, IOC Enrichment, Network Traffic Analysis, Email Security

Frameworks: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST SP 800-61, NIST CSF

Certifications: Security+, Google Cybersecurity Professional, SecAI+ (*in progress*), Splunk Core Certified User (*in progress*)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Security and Compliance Intern

Remote

Artelus.ai

January 2026 – May 2026

- Conducted penetration testing on web applications and API endpoints using Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Postman, Shodan, and SpiderFoot; identified 20+ vulnerabilities across authentication, authorization, and input validation surfaces
- Mapped identified vulnerabilities and security gaps to HIPAA, FDA, and CE compliance requirements; assessed organizational risk posture against regulatory frameworks
- Delivered a comprehensive security assessment report with severity-classified findings, proof-of-concept documentation, and prioritized remediation recommendations to client stakeholders

Graduate Teaching Assistant – Cybersecurity Principles and Practices

Remote

Khoury College of Computer Sciences

January 2026 – May 2026

- Designed and explained 3 course assignments in cryptography, network security, and risk analysis
- Mentored 15+ students and evaluated assignments on Linux hardening, IAM, Bash scripting, network proxy configuration, and cryptographic systems
- Guided students through Incident Response Playbook development covering phishing, credential harvesting, and endpoint threats, incorporating CSIRT roles and containment procedures

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Enterprise SOC Lab | Wazuh, Shuffle SOAR, Docker, Sysmon, TheHive

- Deployed Wazuh SIEM/XDR with centralized log ingestion from Windows workstation and hardened Linux bastion; integrated Shuffle SOAR for automated alert enrichment and triage workflows
- Developed 12 custom detection rules and tuned alert thresholds to reduce false positive rates; validated true/false positives and mapped confirmed IOCs to MITRE ATT&CK
- Built operational dashboards and maintained detection playbooks for phishing triage, brute force escalation, and alert severity classification

Alert Triage & Incident Response | CyberDefenders, Wireshark, VirusTotal

- Investigated 10+ simulated incidents covering malware, phishing, and intrusion scenarios; triaged alerts, extracted IOCs, and mapped findings to MITRE ATT&CK
- Utilized Wireshark for packet-level traffic analysis to identify C2 communication patterns and data exfiltration indicators
- Created structured incident reports documenting investigation methodology, root cause analysis, and remediation actions

Phishing Detection & URL Threat Analysis | Python, VirusTotal, PhishTank, URLScan.io

- Analyzed phishing indicators across URL datasets including domain spoofing, suspicious TLDs, URL obfuscation, misleading content, and fake login forms commonly associated with credential harvesting and BEC campaigns

LEADERSHIP & RECOGNITION

WiCyS Scholarship Recipient – Competitively selected to attend 2026 Women in Cybersecurity Annual Conference

Top 50 Globally – WiCyS Target Cyber Defense Challenge | **6th Place** – SimSpace Cyber Range Challenge

Head of Finance – null NEU Chapter